

Apache OpenOffice

Version 4.1

Calc Guide

AOO Documentation Team

Chapter **14**

Setting up and Customizing Calc

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Note for Mac Users

Some keystrokes and menu items differ on a Mac from those used in Windows and Linux. The table below gives some common substitutions for the instructions in this chapter. For a more detailed list, see the application Help.

<i>Windows/Linux</i>	<i>Mac equivalent</i>	<i>Effect</i>
Tools > Options menu selection	OpenOffice > Preferences	Access setup options
<i>Right-click</i>	<i>Control+click</i>	Open context menu
<i>Ctrl</i> (Control)	⌘ (Command)	Used with other keys
<i>F5</i>	<i>Shift+⌘+F5</i>	Open the Navigator
<i>F11</i>	<i>⌘+T</i>	Open Styles & Formatting window

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Introduction

This chapter describes common customizations. In addition to the options provided, you can customize menus, toolbars, and keyboard shortcuts, add new menus and toolbars, and assign macros to events. However, you cannot customize context (right-click) menus.

Other customizations are made easy by extensions that you can install from the OpenOffice extensions website or other providers.

Note

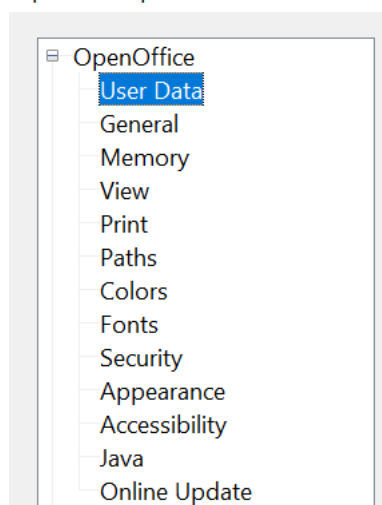
Customizations to menus and toolbars can be saved in a template. To do so, first save them in a document and then save the document as a template as described in Chapter 4 (Using Styles and Templates in Calc).

Choosing Options that Affect all of OpenOffice

This section covers some of the settings that apply to all the components of OpenOffice. Other general options are discussed in Chapter 2 (Setting Up OpenOffice) in the *Getting Started* guide.

- 1) Choose **Tools > Options**. The list on the left-hand side varies depending on which component of OpenOffice is open.
- 2) Click the + sign to the left of *OpenOffice* on the left-hand side. A list of subsections drops down.

Options - OpenOffice - User Data



Note

The **Back** button has the same effect on all pages of the Options dialog. It resets the options to the values that were in place when you launched OpenOffice.

User Data Options

Calc uses the first and last name stored in the *OpenOffice - User Data* page to fill in the *Created* and *Modified* fields in the document properties, and the optional *Author* field, often used in the footer of a printed spreadsheet. Fill in the form on this page.

Print Options

Set the print options to suit your default printer and your preferred printing method. You can change these settings at any time, either through this dialog or during the printing process, by clicking the **Options** button on the Print dialog.

In the Options dialog, click **OpenOffice > Print**.

See Chapter 6 (Printing, Exporting, and E-mailing) for more about the options on this page.

Color Options

On the *OpenOffice - Colors* page (Figure 1), you can specify colors to use in documents. You can select a color from a color table, edit an existing color, and define new colors. These colors are stored in your color palette and are then available in all components of OpenOffice.

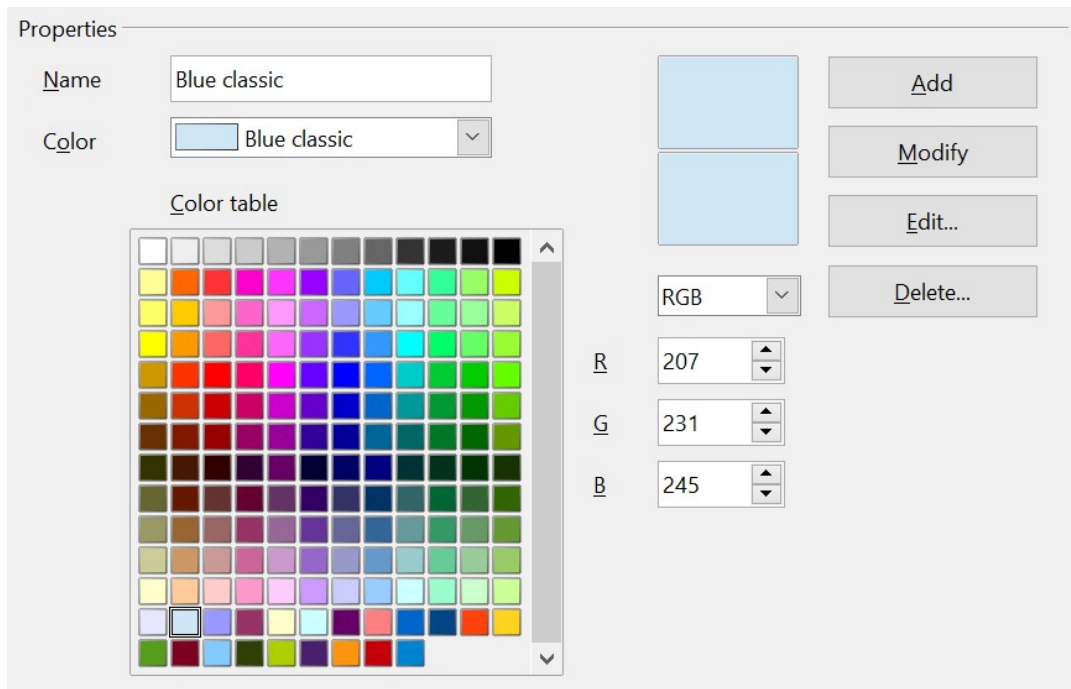


Figure 1: Defining colors to use in color palettes

To modify a color:

- 1) Select the color to be modified, from the list or the color table.
- 2) Enter the new values that define the color. If necessary, change the settings from RGB (Red, Green, Blue) to CMYK (Cyan, Magenta, Yellow, Black) or vice versa. The changed color appears in the lower of the two color preview boxes at the top.
- 3) Modify the *Name* if desired.
- 4) Click the **Modify** button. The newly defined color is now listed in the Color table.

Or, click the **Edit** button to open the Color dialog, shown in Figure 2. Here you can select a color from the color window in the upper left area, or you can enter values on the right using your choice of RGB, CMYK, or HSB (Hue, Saturation, and Brightness) values.

The large color window is linked directly with the color input fields on the right; as you choose a color in the window, the numbers change accordingly. The two color fields at the lower left show the value of the selected color on the left and the currently set value from the color value fields on the right.

Modify the color components as required. Then click **OK** to exit the dialog. The newly defined color now appears in the lower part of the color preview boxes shown in Figure 1. Type a name for this color in the *Name* box, then click the **Add** button. A small box showing the new color is added to the Color table.

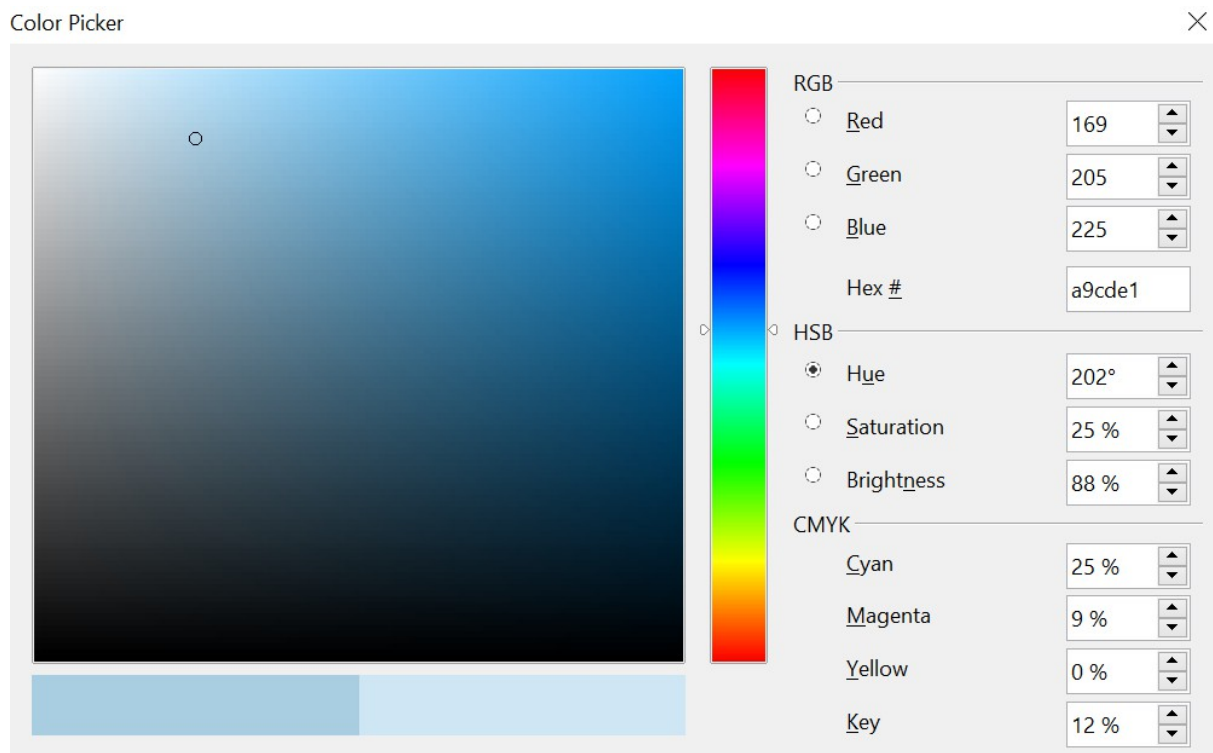


Figure 2: Editing colors

Another way to define or alter colors is through the Colors tab of the Area dialog. You can also use this dialog to save and load palettes, a feature that is not otherwise possible here.

Note In Calc, draw a temporary draw object and use the context menu of this object to open the Area dialog. If you load a palette in one component of OpenOffice, it is only active in that component; the other components keep their own palettes.

Security Options

Use the *OpenOffice - Security* page to choose security options for saving and opening documents that contain macros (Figure 3).

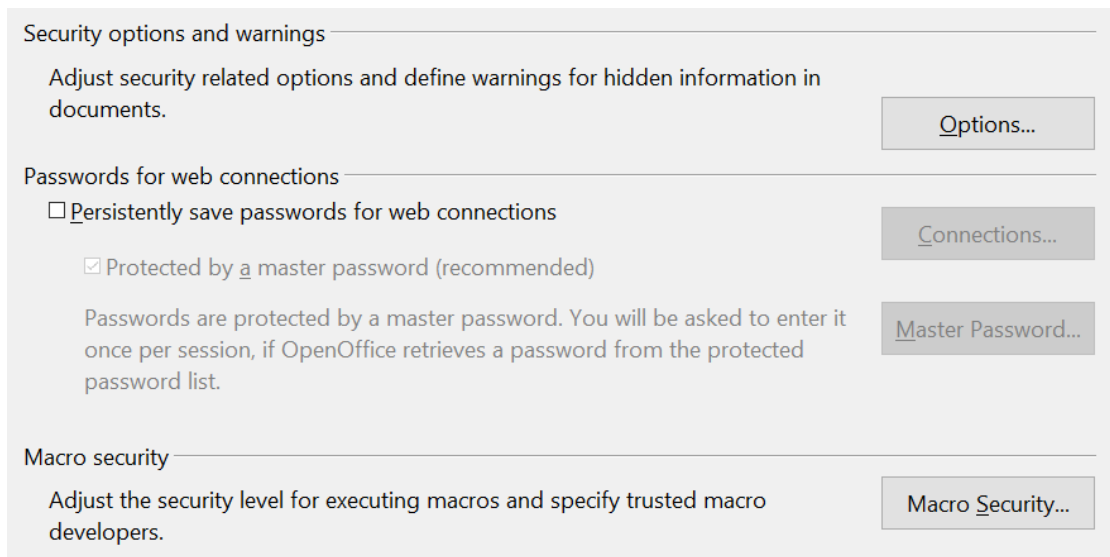


Figure 3: Choosing security options for opening and saving documents

Security options and warnings

If you record changes, save multiple versions, or include hidden information or notes in your documents, and you do not want some recipients to see that information, you can set warnings to remind you to remove this information, or you can have OpenOffice automatically remove some information. Note that, unless removed, much of this information is retained in a file, whether the file is in OpenOffice's default OpenDocument format or has been saved to other formats, including PDF.

Click the **Options** button to open a separate dialog with specific choices (Figure 4).

Macro security

Click the **Macro Security** button to open the Macro Security dialog (not shown here), where you can adjust the security level for executing macros and specify trusted sources.

Security Options and Warnings

The following options are available in the Security options and warnings dialog (Figure 4).

Remove personal information on saving

Select this option to always remove user data from the file properties when saving the file. To manually remove personal information from specific documents, deselect this option and then use the **Delete** button under **File > Properties > General**.

Ctrl-click required to follow hyperlinks

Many people find creation and editing of documents easier when accidental clicks on links don't activate those links.

The other options on this dialog should be self-explanatory.

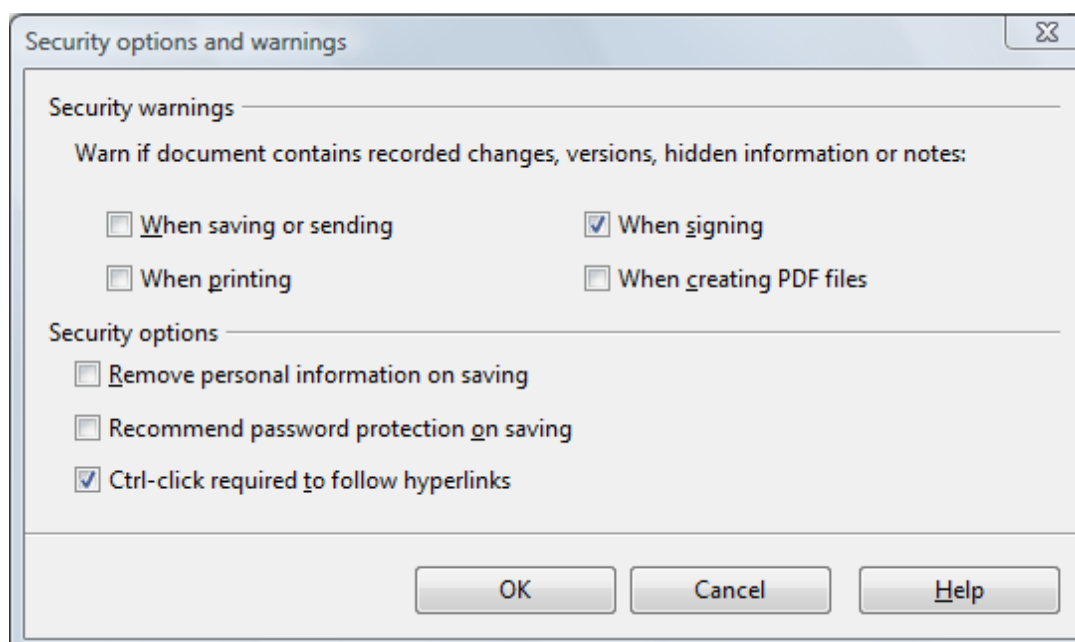


Figure 4: Security options and warnings dialog

Appearance Options

On the *OpenOffice - Appearance* page, you can specify which items are visible and the colors used to display various items (Figure 5).

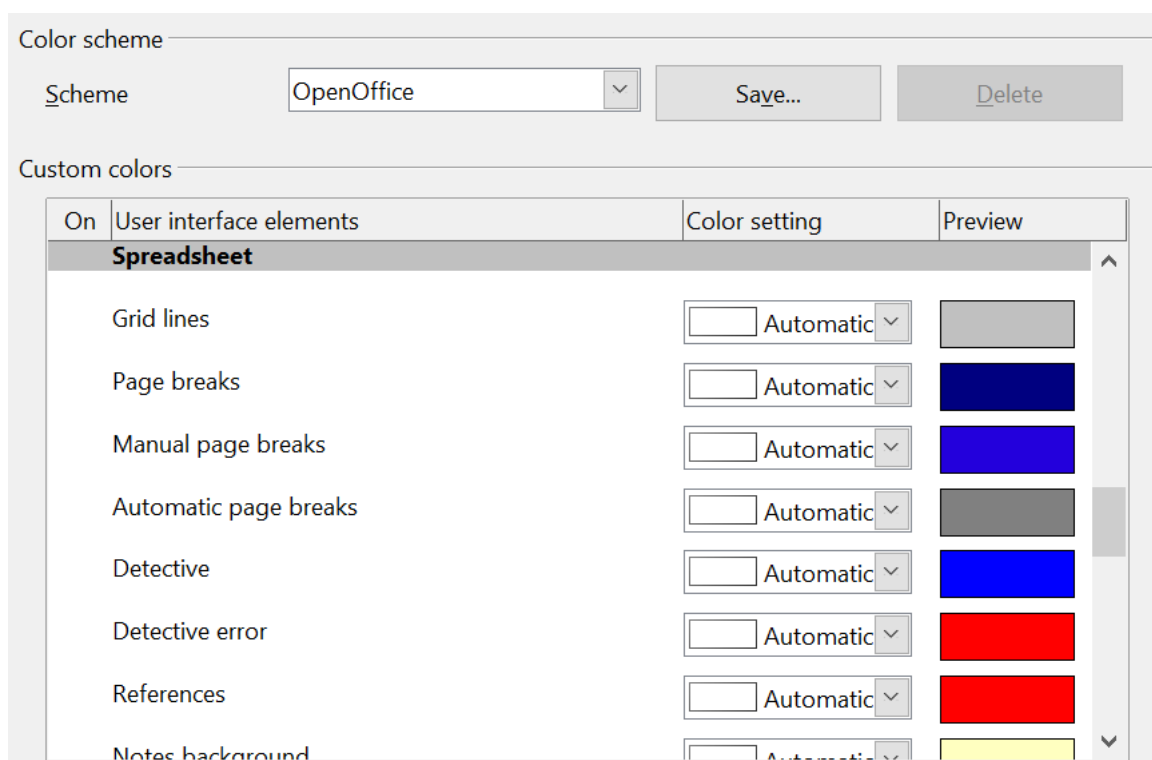


Figure 5: Changing the colors in Calc

Scroll down the page until you find **Spreadsheet**. To change the default color for grid points, click the down arrow by the color and select a new color from the pop-up box.

If you wish to save your color changes as a color scheme, click **Save**, type a name in the *Scheme* box, and then click **OK**.

Choosing Options for Loading and Saving Documents

You can set the Load/Save options to suit your working style. This chapter describes only a few of the options, those more relevant to working with Calc. See Chapter 2 (Setting Up OpenOffice) in the *Getting Started* guide for a description of the other options.

If the Options dialog is not already open, click **Tools > Options**. Click the + sign to the left of **Load/Save** to display the list of load/save options pages (Figure 6).

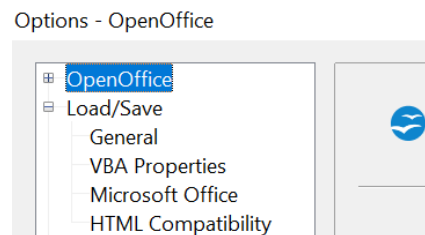


Figure 6: Load/Save options

General Load/Save Options

Most of the choices on the *Load/Save - General* page (Figure 7) are familiar to users of other office suites. Those specific to OpenOffice are in the *Default file format and ODF settings* section.

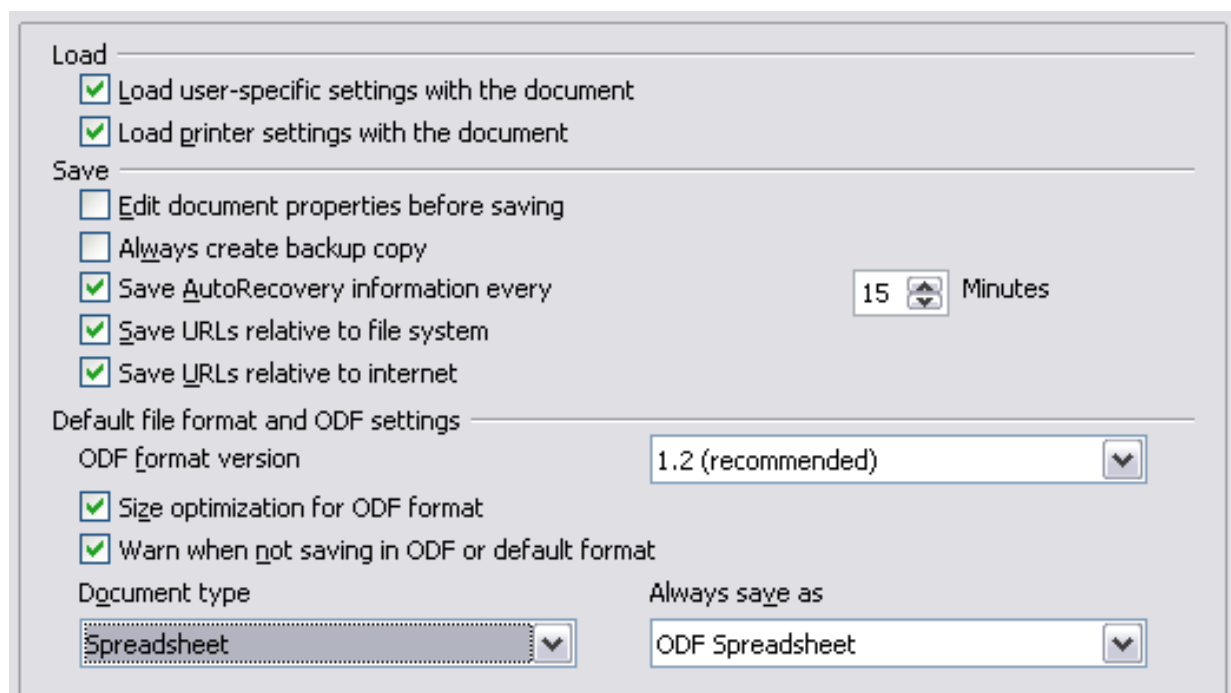


Figure 7: Choosing Load and Save options

ODF format version

OpenOffice saves documents by default in OpenDocument Format (ODF) version 1.2 Extended. While this allows for improved functionality, it may introduce

backwards compatibility issues. When a file saved in ODF 1.2 Extended is opened in an older version of OpenOffice (using ODF 1.0/1.1), some of its advanced features may be lost. Two notable examples are cross-references to headings and the formatting of numbered lists.

Size optimization for ODF format

OpenOffice documents are XML files. When you select this option, OpenOffice writes the XML data without indents and line breaks. If you want to view the XML files in a text editor in a structured format, deselect this option.

Document type

If you routinely share documents with Microsoft Excel users, you may want to change the **Always save as** attribute for spreadsheets to one of the Excel formats. Excel can open and save in the .ods format native to OpenOffice.

Note

Although OpenOffice can open files in the .xlsx format produced by Microsoft Office, it cannot save in this format.

VBA Properties Load/Save Options

On the *Load/Save - VBA Properties* page, you can choose whether to keep any macros in Microsoft Office documents that are opened in OpenOffice (Figure 8).

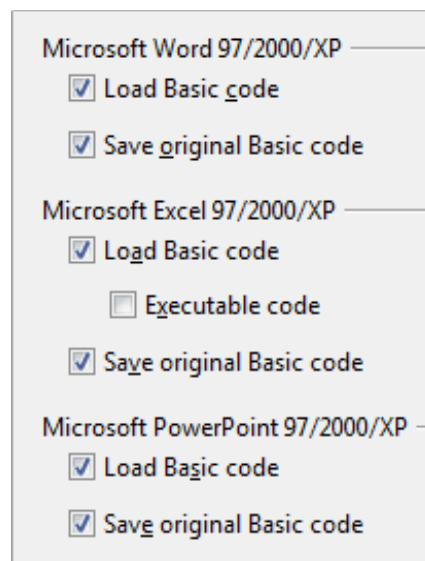


Figure 8: Choosing Load/Save VBA Properties

- If you choose **Save original Basic code**, the macros will not work in OpenOffice, but are retained if you save the file in Microsoft Office format.
- If you choose **Load Basic code**, the code is saved in an OpenOffice document but is not retained if you save it in Microsoft Office format.
- If you are importing a Microsoft Excel file containing VBA (Visual Basic for Applications) code, you can select the **Executable code** option. Normally, the code is preserved but rendered inactive. With this option, the code is ready to be executed. VBA code and OpenOffice Basic code are very different. It's very unlikely a VBA macro will run correctly in OpenOffice without modifications.

Microsoft Office Load/Save Options

On the *Load/Save - Microsoft Office* page, you can choose what to do when importing and exporting Microsoft Office OLE objects (linked or embedded objects or documents such as spreadsheets or equations) (Figure 9).

Select the [L] options to convert Microsoft OLE objects into the corresponding OpenOffice OLE objects when a Microsoft document is loaded into OpenOffice (mnemonic: “L” for “load”).

Select the [S] options to convert OpenOffice OLE objects into corresponding Microsoft OLE objects when a document is saved in a Microsoft format (mnemonic: “S” for “save”).

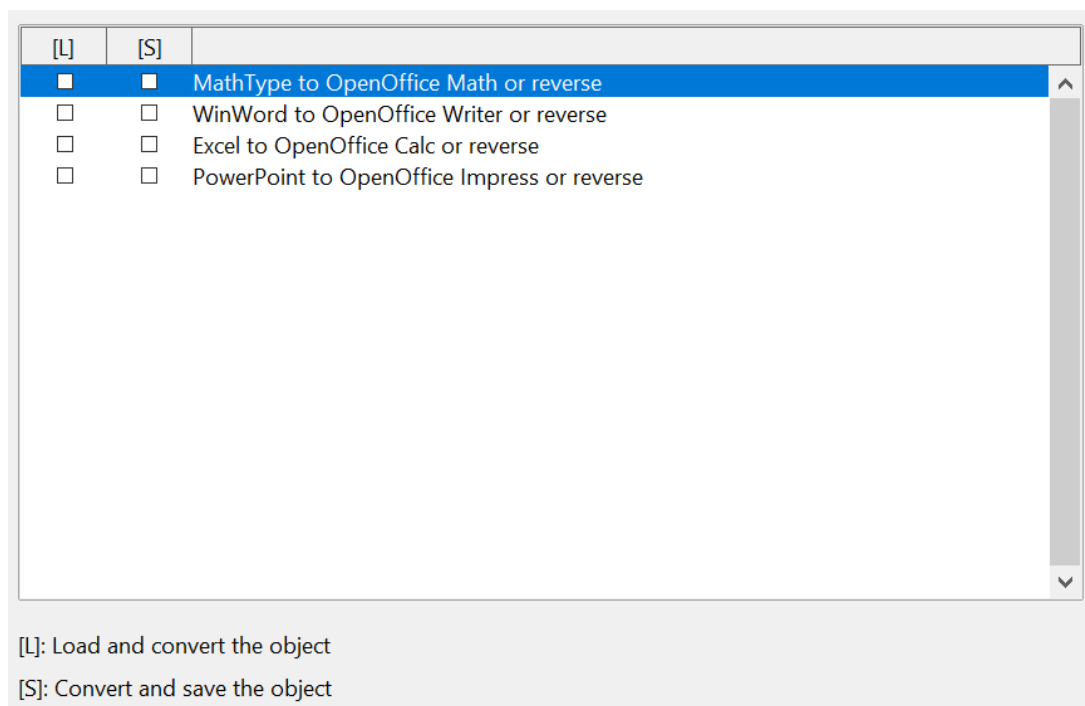


Figure 9: Choosing Load/Save Microsoft Office options

HTML compatibility Load/Save Options

Choices made on the *Load/Save - HTML Compatibility* page (Figure 10) affect HTML pages imported into OpenOffice and those exported from OpenOffice. See *HTML documents; importing/exporting* in the Help for more information.

The main items of interest for Calc users are in the *Export* section: *OpenOffice Basic* and *Display warning*.

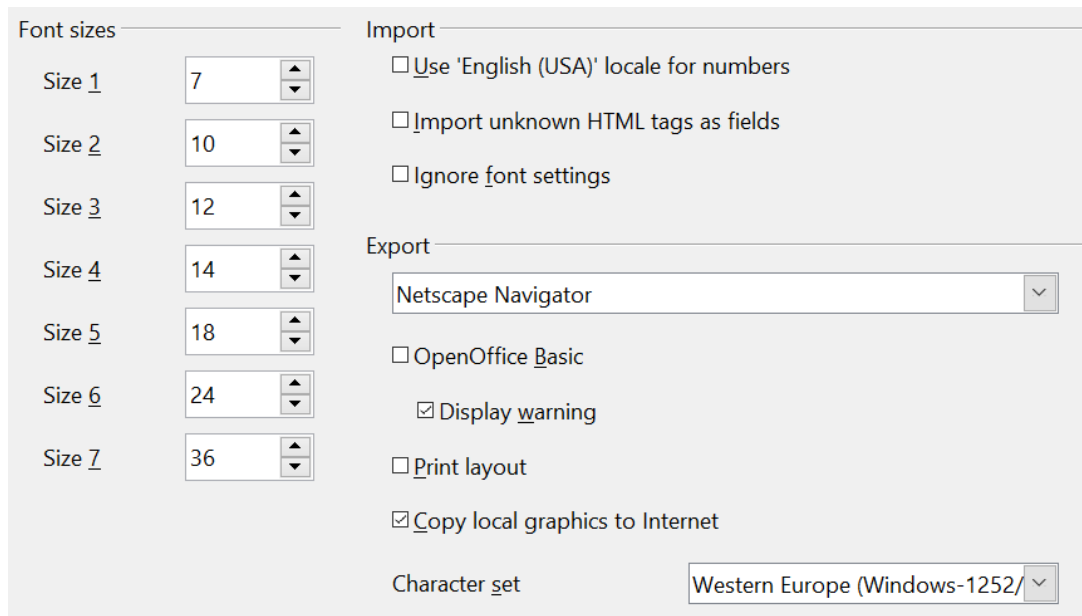
Export - OpenOffice Basic

Select this option to include OpenOffice Basic macros (scripts) when exporting to HTML format. You must activate this option *before* you create the OpenOffice Basic macro., otherwise, the script will not be inserted. OpenOffice Basic macros must be located in the header of the HTML document. Once you have created the macro in the OpenOffice Basic IDE (Integrated Development Environment), it appears in the source text of the HTML document in the header.

To have the macro run automatically when the HTML document opens, choose **Tools > Customize > Events**. See Chapter 12 (Calc Macros) for more information.

Export - Display warning

When the **OpenOffice Basic** option (see above) is *not* selected, the **Display warning** option becomes available (Figure 10). If the **Display warning** option is selected, then when exporting to HTML, a warning is shown that OpenOffice Basic macros will be lost.



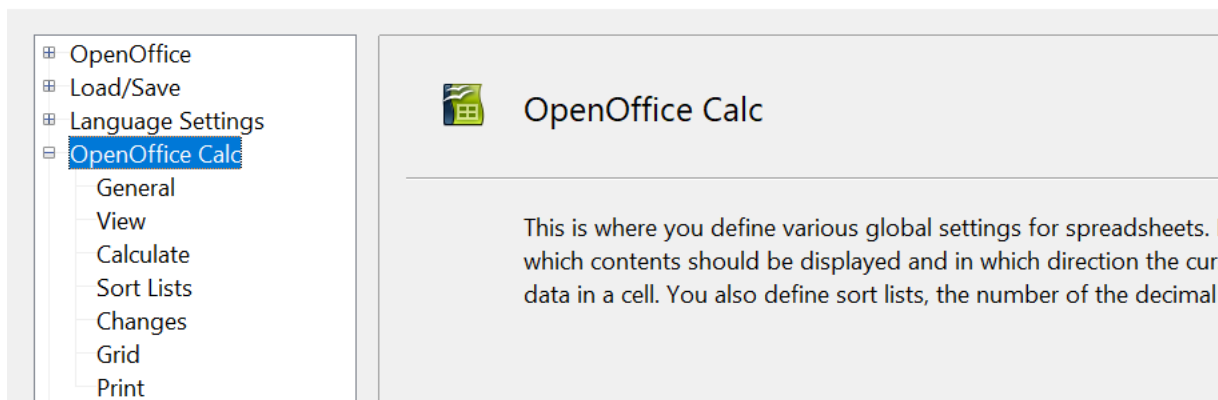
The screenshot shows the 'Font sizes' and 'Import'/'Export' sections of the OpenOffice Options dialog. The 'Font sizes' section on the left has seven rows, each with a label (Size 1 to Size 7) and a spin box. The values are: Size 1: 7, Size 2: 10, Size 3: 12, Size 4: 14, Size 5: 18, Size 6: 24, Size 7: 36. The 'Import' section on the right has three checkboxes: 'Use 'English (USA)' locale for numbers' (unchecked), 'Import unknown HTML tags as fields' (unchecked), and 'Ignore font settings' (unchecked). The 'Export' section has a dropdown menu set to 'Netscape Navigator'. Below it are four checkboxes: 'OpenOffice Basic' (unchecked), 'Display warning' (checked), 'Print layout' (unchecked), and 'Copy local graphics to Internet' (checked). At the bottom, the 'Character set' dropdown is set to 'Western Europe (Windows-1252)'.

Figure 10: Choosing HTML compatibility options

Choosing Options for Calc

In the Options dialog, click the + sign to the left of *OpenOffice Calc* on the left-hand side as shown below. A list of subsections drops down.

Options - OpenOffice Calc



The screenshot shows the 'Options - OpenOffice Calc' dialog. On the left is a tree view with the following items: 'OpenOffice', 'Load/Save', 'Language Settings', 'OpenOffice Calc' (selected and expanded), 'General', 'View', 'Calculate', 'Sort Lists', 'Changes', 'Grid', and 'Print'. The main area on the right has the 'OpenOffice Calc' icon and title. Below the title is a text box that reads: 'This is where you define various global settings for spreadsheets. which contents should be displayed and in which direction the cur data in a cell. You also define sort lists, the number of the decimal'.

General Options for Calc

In the Options dialog, choose **OpenOffice Calc > General** (Figure 11).

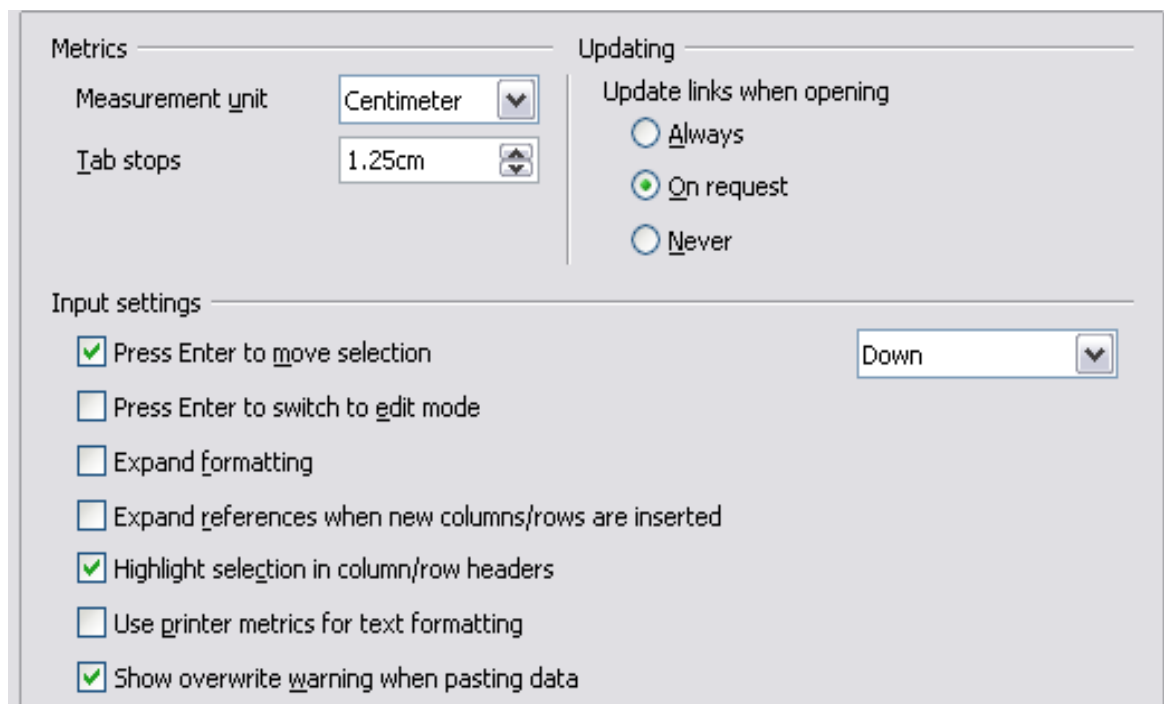


Figure 11: Selecting general options for Calc

Metrics Section

Choose the unit of measurement used in spreadsheets and the default tab stops distance.

Updating Section

Choose whether to update links when opening a document always, only on request, or never. Regardless of this setting, you can manually update links at any time. You may want to avoid updating links when opening documents if they often contain many charts or linked graphics that would slow down file loading.

Input Settings Section

Press Enter to move selection

Specifies that pressing *Enter* moves the cursor to another cell. If this option is selected, you can also choose the direction the cursor moves: up, down, left, or right. If this option is **not** selected, pressing *Enter* completes data entry for a cell but does not move the cursor.

Press Enter to switch to edit mode

Specifies that pressing *Enter* puts the selected cell into edit mode.

Expand formatting

Specifies whether to automatically apply the formatting attributes of an inserted cell to empty adjacent cells. If, for example, an inserted cell has the bold attribute, this attribute will also apply to empty adjacent cells. However, cells that already have a special format will not be modified by this function. To see the affected range, press *Ctrl+** (multiplication sign on the number pad). The format will also apply to all new values inserted within this range.

Expand references when new columns/rows are inserted

Specifies whether to expand references when inserting columns or rows adjacent to the reference range. This is only possible if the reference range, where the column or row is inserted, originally spanned at least two cells in the desired direction.

Example: If the range A1:B1 is referenced in a formula and you insert a new column after column B, the reference is expanded to A1:C1. If the range A1:B1 is referenced and a new row is inserted under row 1, the reference is not expanded, since there is only a single cell in the vertical direction.

If you insert rows or columns in the middle of a reference area, the reference is always expanded.

Highlight selection in column/row headings

Specifies whether to highlight column and row headers in the selected columns or rows.

Use printer metrics for text formatting

Specifies that printer metrics are applied for both printing and formatting the display on the screen. If this option is not selected, a printer-independent layout is used for screen display and printing.

Show overwrite warning when pasting data

Specifies that, if you paste cells from the clipboard to a cell range that is not empty, a warning appears.

View Options for Calc

In the Options dialog, choose **OpenOffice Calc > View** (Figure 12).

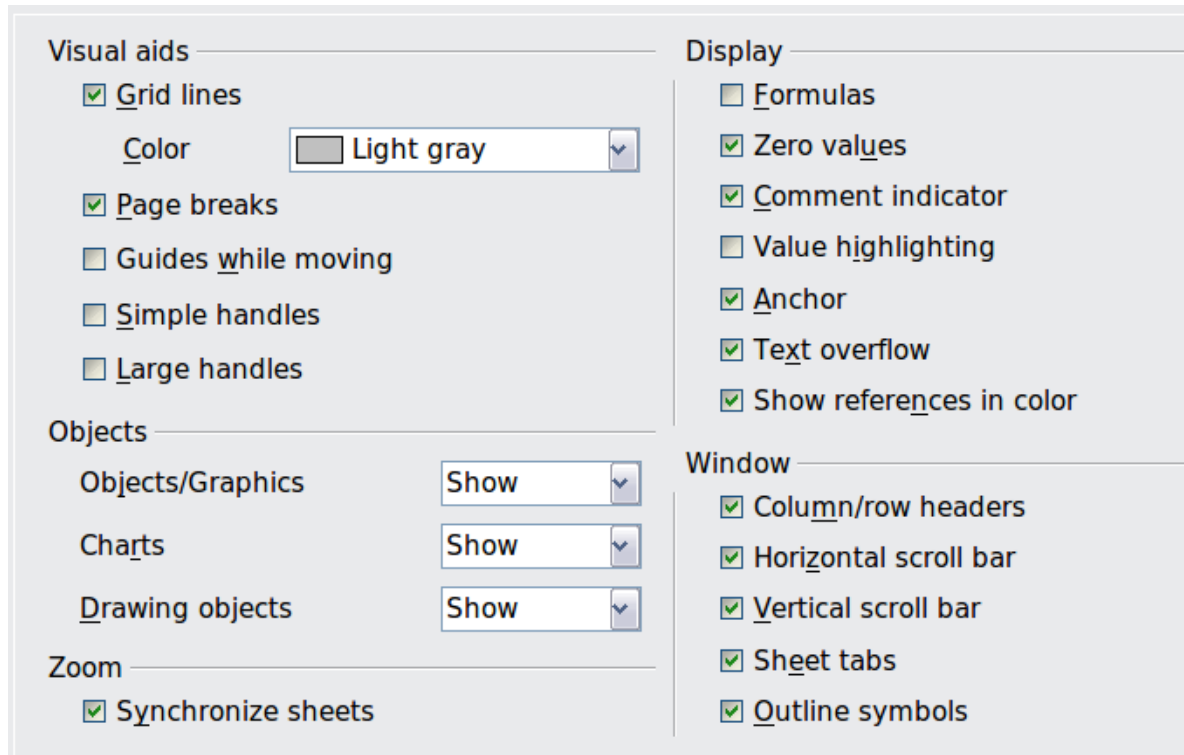


Figure 12: Selecting view options for Calc

Visual Aids Section

Specifies which lines are displayed.

Grid lines

Specifies whether to display grid lines between the cells when viewed onscreen. If this option is selected, you can also specify the color for the grid lines in the current document. The color choice overrides the selection made in **Tools > Options > OpenOffice > Appearance > Spreadsheet > Grid lines**.

For *printing*, choose **Format > Page > Sheet** and mark the **Grid** option.

Page breaks

Specifies whether to view the page breaks within a defined print area.

Guides while moving

Specifies whether to view guides when moving drawings, frames, graphics, and other objects. These guides help you align objects.

Simple handles

Specifies whether to display the handles (the eight points on a selection box) as simple squares without a 3D effect.

Large handles

Specifies that larger-than-normal handles (the eight points on a selection box) are displayed.

Display Section

Select various options for the screen display.

Formulas

Specifies whether to show formulas instead of results in the cells.

Zero values

Specifies whether to show numbers with the value of 0.

Comment indicator

Specifies that a small rectangle is shown in the top right corner of the cell when a comment exists for that cell. The text of the comment is shown when you hover the pointer over the cell, **if** tips are enabled under **Tools > Options > OpenOffice > General**.

To display a comment permanently, right-click on the cell and select **Show comment** from the pop-up menu.

Value highlighting

Select this option to highlight all values in the sheet. Text is highlighted in black; numbers, including dates and logical values, in blue; and formula results in green.

When this command is active, any colors assigned in the document are not displayed.

Anchor

Specifies whether the anchor icon is displayed when an inserted object, such as a graphic, is selected.

Text overflow

If a cell contains text that is wider than the width of the cell, the text is displayed over empty neighboring cells in the same row. If there is no empty neighboring cell, a small triangle at the cell border indicates that the text continues.

Show references in color

Specifies that each reference is highlighted in color in the formula. The cell range is also enclosed by a colored border as soon as the cell containing the reference is selected for editing.

Objects Section

Specifies whether to display or hide objects in three object groups: objects and graphics, charts, and drawing objects.

Window Section

Specifies whether some elements are visible onscreen: column/row headers, horizontal scrollbar, vertical scrollbar, sheet tabs, and outline symbols.

If the **Sheet tabs** option is not selected, you can only switch between the sheets by using the Navigator.

Note that there is a slider between the horizontal scrollbar and the sheet tabs that may be set to one end.

Zoom Section

Select the **Synchronize sheets** option to apply any selected zoom factor to all sheets in the spreadsheet. If this option is not selected, separate zoom factors can be applied to individual sheets.

Calculate Options

In the Options dialog, choose **OpenOffice Calc > Calculate** (Figure 13).

Use this page to define the calculation settings for spreadsheets.

The screenshot shows the 'Calculate' options dialog in OpenOffice Calc. It is divided into two main sections: 'Iterative references' and 'Date'. The 'Iterative references' section has a checkbox for 'Iterations' which is unchecked. Below it are two input fields: 'Steps' with the value '100' and 'Minimum Change' with the value '0.001'. The 'Date' section has three radio button options: '12/30/1899 (default)' (selected), '01/01/1900 (StarCalc 1.0)', and '01/01/1904'. Below these sections is a list of checkboxes: 'Case sensitive' (checked), 'Precision as shown' (unchecked), 'Search criteria = and <> must apply to whole cells' (checked), 'Enable regular expressions in formulas' (checked), 'Automatically find column and row labels' (checked), and 'Limit decimals for general number format' (unchecked). To the right of the last checkbox is a 'Decimal places' input field with the value '0' and up/down arrow buttons.

Figure 13: Calc calculation options

Iterative References Section

Iterative references are formulas that are continuously repeated until the problem is solved. In this section, you can choose the number of approximation steps carried out during iterative calculations and the degree of precision of the answer.

Iterations

Select this option to enable iterations, that is, repetitions of a sequence of instructions. If this option is not selected, an [iterative reference](#) causes an error message.

Steps

Sets the maximum number of iteration steps.

Minimum Change

Specifies the difference between two consecutive iteration step results. If the result of the iteration is lower than the minimum change value, then the iteration will stop.

Date Section

Select the start date for the internal conversion from days to numbers.

12/30/1899 (default)

Sets 12/30/1899 as day zero.

01/01/1900 (StarCalc 1.0)

Sets 1/1/1900 as day zero. Use this setting for StarCalc 1.0 spreadsheets containing date entries.

01/01/1904

Sets 1/1/1904 as day zero. Use this setting for spreadsheets imported in a foreign format.

Other Options

Specify a variety of options relevant to spreadsheet calculation.

Case sensitive

Specifies whether to distinguish between upper and lower case in texts when comparing cell contents. The EXACT text function is always case-sensitive, independent of the settings in this dialog.

Decimal places

Defines the number of decimals to be displayed for numbers with the Standard number format. The numbers are displayed as rounded numbers, but they are not saved as such.

Precision as shown

Specifies whether to make calculations using the rounded values displayed in the sheet. Charts will be shown with the displayed values. If this option is **not** selected, the displayed numbers are rounded, but they are calculated internally using the non-rounded number.

Search criteria = and <> must apply to whole cells

Specifies that the search criteria you set for the Calc database functions must match the whole cell exactly.

This search:

win

win.*

.*win

.*win.*

Has this result:Finds *win*, but not *win95*, *os2win*, or *upwind*Finds *win* and *win95*, but not *os2win* or *upwind*Finds *win* and *os2win*, but not *win95* or *upwind*Finds *win*, *win95*, *os2win*, and *upwind*

If this option is **not** selected, the *win* search pattern acts like *.*win.** —the search pattern can be at any position within the cell when searching with the Calc database functions.

Enable regular expressions in formulas

Specifies that regular expressions are enabled when searching and for character string comparisons. This relates to database functions, specifically VLOOKUP, HLOOKUP, and SEARCH.

Automatically find column and row labels

Specifies that you can use the text in any cell as a label for the column below the text or the row to the right of the text. The text must consist of at least one word and must not contain any operators.

Example: Cell E5 contains the text *Europe*. Below, in cell E6, is the value 100, and in cell E7, the value 200. If the **Automatically find column and row labels** option is selected, you can write the following formula in cell A1: =SUM(Europe).

Sort Lists Options

In the Options dialog, choose **OpenOffice Calc > Sort Lists** (Figure 14). Sort lists are used for more than sorting, for example, filling a series of cells during data entry. In addition to the supplied lists, you can define and edit your own lists, as described in “Defining a fill series” in Chapter 2 (Entering, Editing, and Formatting Data).

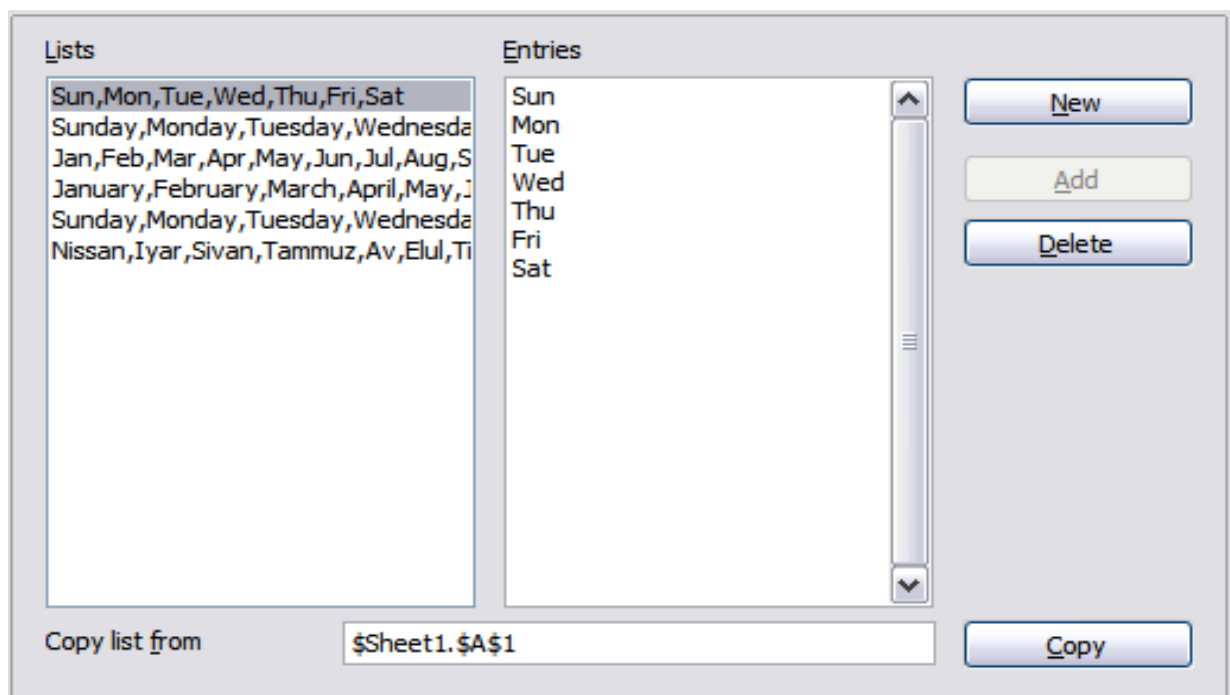


Figure 14: Defining sorting lists in Calc

Changes Options

In the Options dialog, choose **OpenOffice Calc > Changes** (Figure 15).

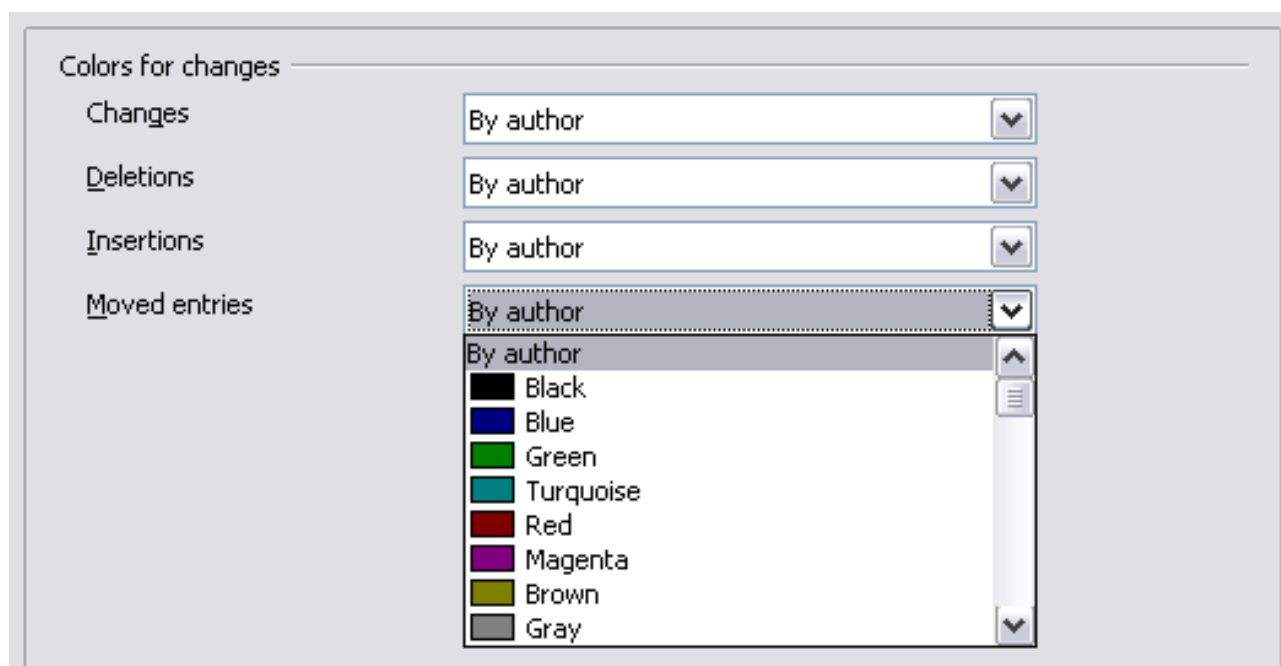


Figure 15: Calc options for highlighting changes

On this page, you can specify options for highlighting recorded changes in spreadsheets. You can assign specific colors for insertions, deletions, and other changes, or you can let Calc assign colors based on the author of the change; in the latter case, one color will apply to all changes made by that author.

Grid Options

The Grid page defines the grid settings for spreadsheets. Using a grid helps you determine the exact position of any charts or other objects you might add to a spreadsheet. You can also set this grid in line with the snap grid.

If you have activated the snap grid but wish to move or create individual objects without snap positions, you can press the *Ctrl* key to deactivate the snap grid for as long as needed.

In the Options dialog, choose **OpenOffice Calc > Grid** (Figure 16).

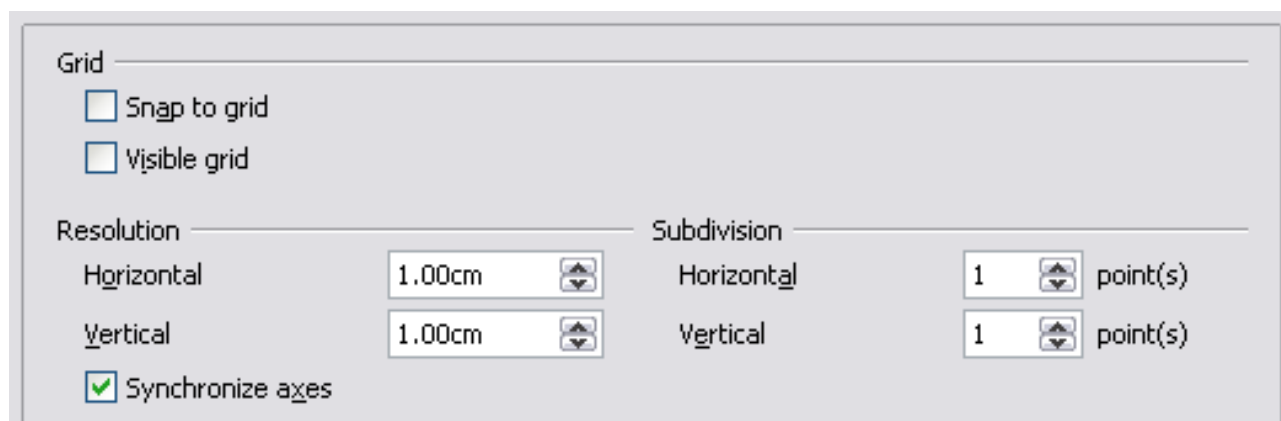


Figure 16: Calc grid options

Grid Section

Snap to grid activates the snap function.

Visible grid displays grid points on the screen. These points are not printed.

Resolution Section

Here you can set the unit of distance for the spacing between horizontal and vertical grid points, and subdivisions (intermediate points) of the grid.

Synchronize axes changes the current grid settings symmetrically.

Print Options

In the Options dialog, choose **OpenOffice Calc > Print**. See Chapter 6 (Printing, Exporting, and E-mailing) for more about the options on this page.

Controlling Calc's AutoCorrect Functions

Some people find some or all of the items in OpenOffice's AutoCorrect function annoying, because they change what you type, even if you don't want it to. Many people find some of the AutoCorrect functions quite helpful; if you do, then select the relevant options. But if you find unexplained changes appearing in your document, this is a good place to look to find the cause.

To open the AutoCorrect dialog, click **Tools > AutoCorrect Options**. (You need to have a document open for this menu item to appear.)

In Calc, this dialog has four tabs, as shown in Figure 17 below. Options are described in the Help; many will be familiar to users of other office suites.

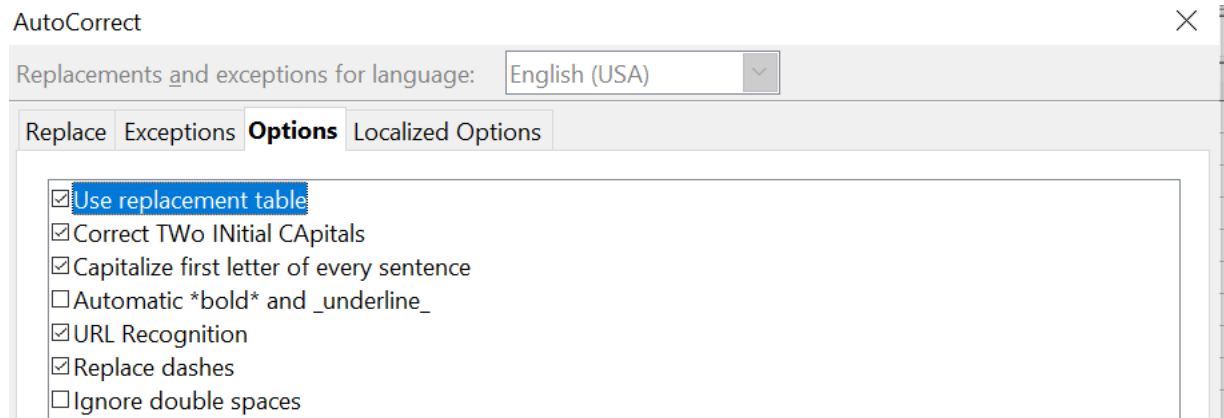


Figure 17: The AutoCorrect dialog in Calc

Customizing the User Interface

Customizing the Menu Font

If you want to change the menu font from that supplied by OpenOffice to the system font for your operating system, do this:

- 1) Choose **Tools > Options > OpenOffice > View**.
- 2) Check **Use system font for user interface** and click **OK**.

Customizing Menu Content

In addition to changing the menu font, you can add and rearrange items on the menu bar, add items to menus, and make other changes.

To customize menus:

- 1) Choose **Tools > Customize**.
- 2) On the **Customize** dialog, pick the **Menus** tab (Figure 18).

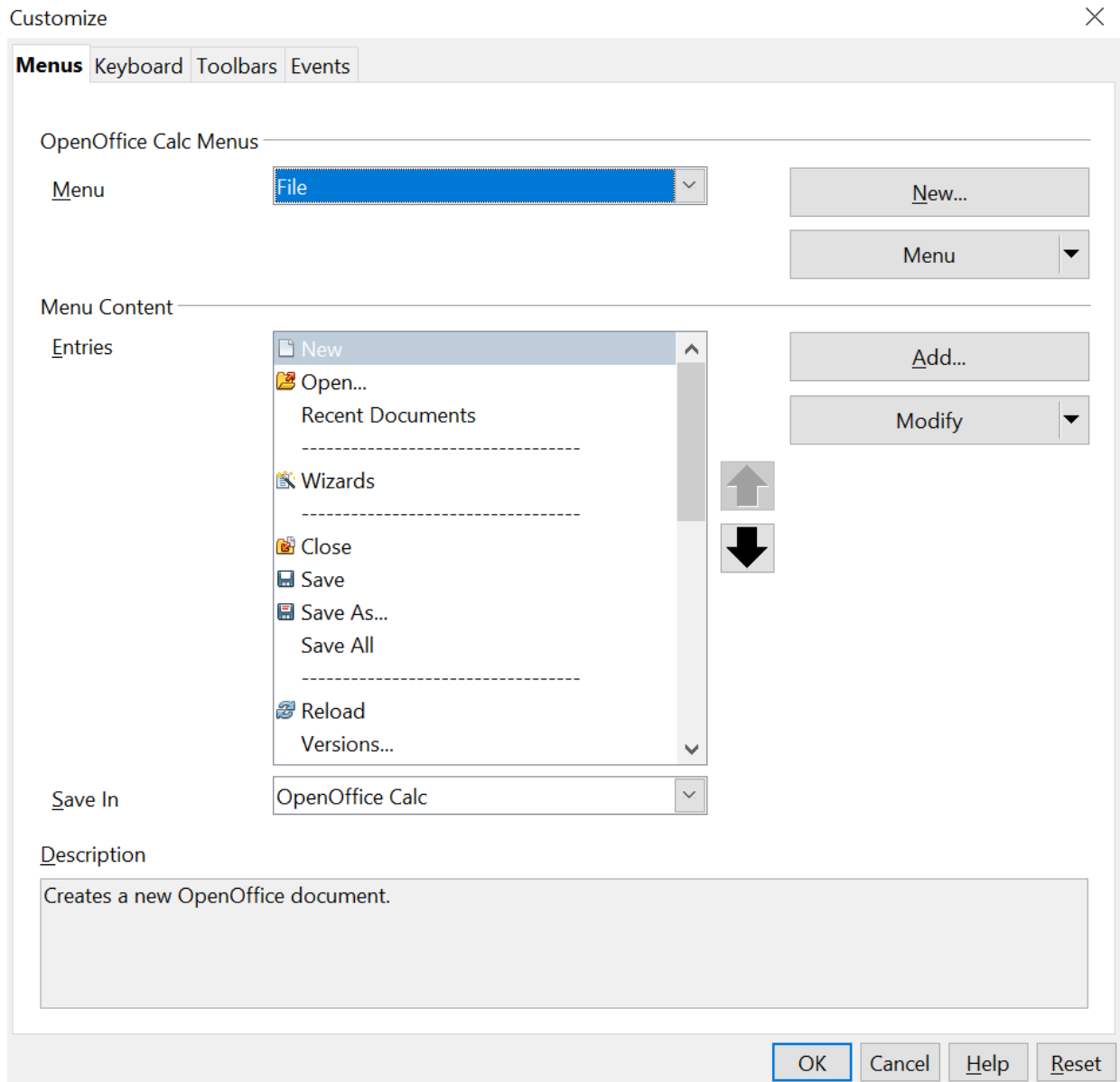


Figure 18: The Menus tab of the Customize dialog

- 3) In the **Save In** drop-down list, choose whether to save this changed menu for Calc or a selected document.
- 4) In the section **OpenOffice Calc Menus**, select from the **Menu** drop-down list the menu that you want to customize. The list includes all the main menus, as well as sub-menus, which are menus contained under another menu. For example, in addition to *File*, *Edit*, *View*, and so on, there is *File | Send* and *File | Templates*. The commands available for the selected menu are shown in the central part of the dialog.

- 5) To customize the selected menu, click on the **Menu** or **Modify** buttons. You can also add commands to a menu by clicking on the **Add** button. These actions are described in the following sections. Use the up and down arrows next to the Entries list to move the selected menu item to a different position.
- 6) When you've finished your changes, click **OK** to save them.

Creating a New Menu

In the Customize dialog, click **New** to display the dialog shown in Figure 19.

- 1) Type a name for your new menu in the **Menu name** box.
- 2) Use the up and down arrow buttons to move the new menu into the required position on the menu bar. Click **OK** to save.

The new menu now appears on the list of menus in the Customize dialog. (It will appear on the menu bar itself after you save your customizations.)

After creating a new menu, you need to add some commands to it, as described in “Adding a Command to a Menu” on page 23.

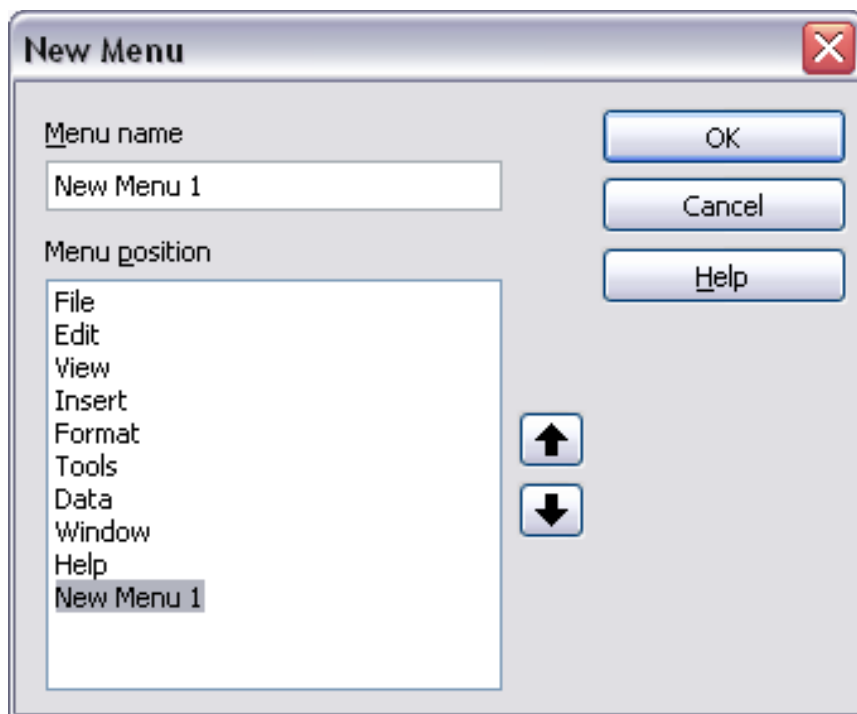


Figure 19: Adding a new menu

Modifying Existing Menus

To modify an existing menu, select it in the Menu list and click the **Menu** button to drop down a list of modifications: **Move**, **Rename**, **Delete**. Not all of these modifications can be applied to every entry in the Menu list. For example, **Rename** and **Delete** are not available for the supplied menus.

To move a menu (such as *File*), choose **Menu > Move**. A dialog similar to the one shown in Figure 19 (but without the **Menu name** box) opens. Use the up and down arrow buttons to move the menu into the required position.

To move submenus (such as *File | Send*), select the main menu (File) in the Menu list and then, in the Menu Content section of the dialog, select the submenu (Send) in the Entries list and use the arrow keys to move it up or down in the sequence. Submenus

are easily identified in the Entries list by a small black triangle on the right side of the name.

In addition to renaming, you can specify a keyboard shortcut that allows you to select a menu command, when you press **Alt+** an underlined letter in a menu command.

- 1) Select a menu or menu entry.
- 2) Click the **Menu** button and select **Rename**.
- 3) Add a tilde (~) in front of the letter that you want to use as an accelerator. For example, to select the Save All command by pressing **Alt+V**, enter **Save All**.

Adding a Command to a Menu

You can add commands to the supplied menus and to menus you have created. On the Customize dialog, select the menu in the Menu list and click the **Add** button in the Menu Content section of the dialog (Figure 20).

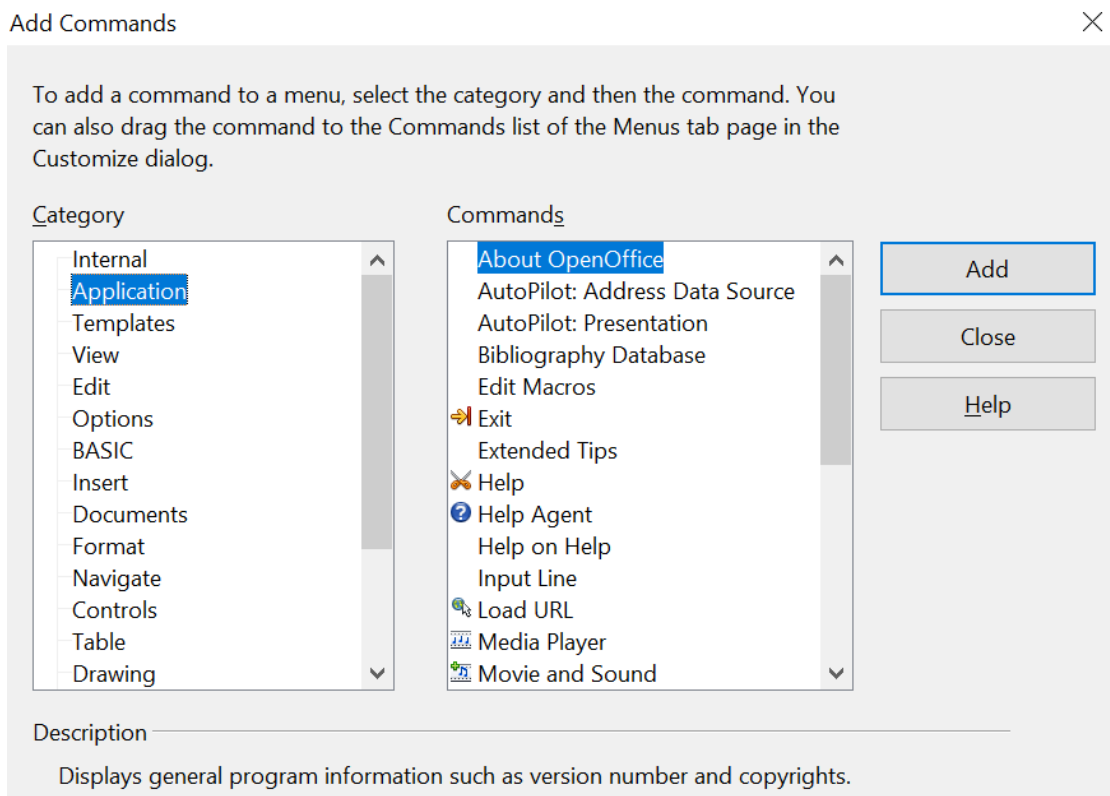


Figure 20: Adding a command to a menu

On the Add Commands dialog, select a category and then the command, and click **Add**. The dialog remains open, so that you can select several commands. When you have finished adding commands, click **Close**. Back on the Customize dialog, you can use the up and down arrow buttons to arrange the commands in your preferred sequence.

Modifying Menu Entries

In addition to changing the sequence of entries on a menu or submenu, you can add submenus, rename or delete the entries, and add group separators.

To begin, select the menu or submenu in the Menu list near the top of the Customize tab, then select the entry in the Entries list under Menu Content. Click the **Modify** button and choose the required action from the drop-down list of actions.

Most of the actions should be self-explanatory. **Begin a group** adds a separator line after the highlighted entry.

Customizing Toolbars

You can customize toolbars in several ways, including choosing which icons are visible, and locking the position of a docked toolbar, as described in Chapter 1 (Introducing OpenOffice) of the *Getting Started* guide. This section describes how to create new toolbars and add other icons (commands) to the list of those available on a toolbar.

To get to the toolbar customization dialog, do any of the following:

- On the toolbar, click the arrow at the end of the toolbar and choose **Customize Toolbar**.
- Choose **View > Toolbars > Customize** from the menu bar.
- Choose **Tools > Customize** from the menu bar and pick the **Toolbars** tab (Figure 21).

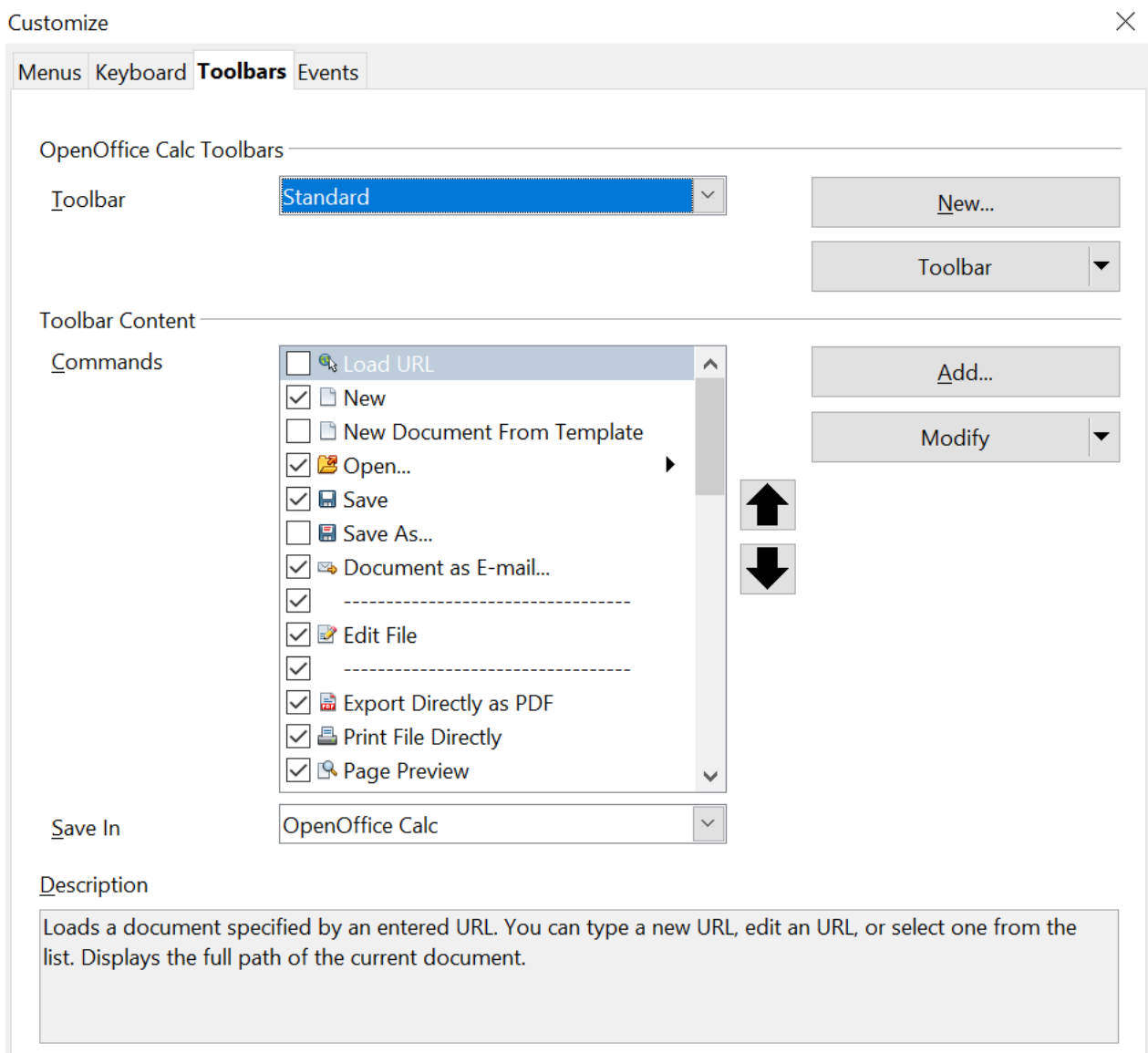


Figure 21: The Toolbars tab of the Customize dialog

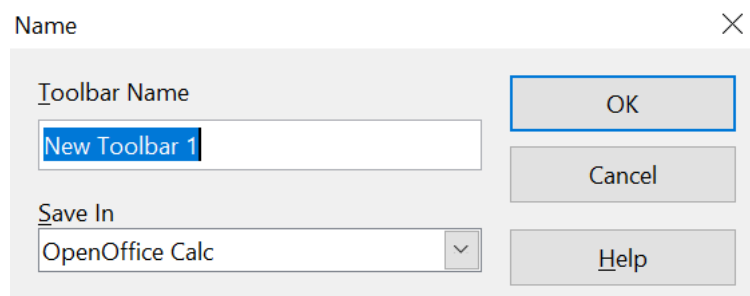
To customize toolbars:

- 1) In the **Save In** drop-down list, choose whether to save this changed toolbar for Calc or for a selected document.
- 2) In the section **OpenOffice Calc Toolbars**, select from the **Toolbar** drop-down list the toolbar that you want to customize.
- 3) You can create a new toolbar by clicking on the **New** button, or customize existing toolbars by clicking on the **Toolbar** or **Modify** buttons, and add commands to a toolbar by clicking on the **Add** button. These actions are described below.
- 4) When you have finished making all your changes, click **OK** to save them.

Creating a New Toolbar

To create a new toolbar:

- 1) Choose **Tools > Customize > Toolbars** from the menu bar.
- 2) Click **New**. On the Name dialog shown below, type the new toolbar's name and choose from the **Save In** drop-down list where to save this changed toolbar: for **Calc** or a selected document.



The new toolbar now appears on the list of toolbars in the Customize dialog. After creating a new toolbar, you need to add commands to it, as described below.

Adding a Command to a Toolbar

If the list of available buttons for a toolbar does not include all the commands you want on that toolbar, you can add commands. When you create a new toolbar, you need to add commands to it.

- 1) On the Toolbars tab of the Customize dialog, select the toolbar in the Toolbar list and click the **Add** button in the Toolbar Content section of the dialog.
- 2) The Add Commands dialog is the same as that for adding commands to menus (Figure 20). Select a category and then the command, and click **Add**. The dialog remains open, so that you can select several commands. When you have finished adding commands, click **Close**. If you insert an item that does not have an associated icon, the toolbar will display the full name of the item. The next section describes how to choose an icon for a toolbar command.
- 3) Back on the Customize dialog, you can use the up and down arrow buttons to arrange the commands in your preferred sequence.
- 4) When you are done making changes, click **OK** to save.

Choosing Icons for Toolbar Commands

Toolbar buttons usually have icons rather than words on them. But not every command has an associated icon.

To choose an icon for a command, select the command and click **Modify > Change icon**. On the Change Icon dialog (Figure 22), scroll through the available icons, select one, and click **OK** to assign it to the command.

To use a custom icon, create it in a graphics program and import it into OpenOffice by clicking the **Import** button on the Change Icon dialog. Custom icons must be 16 x 16 or 26 x 26 pixels in size and cannot contain more than 256 colors.

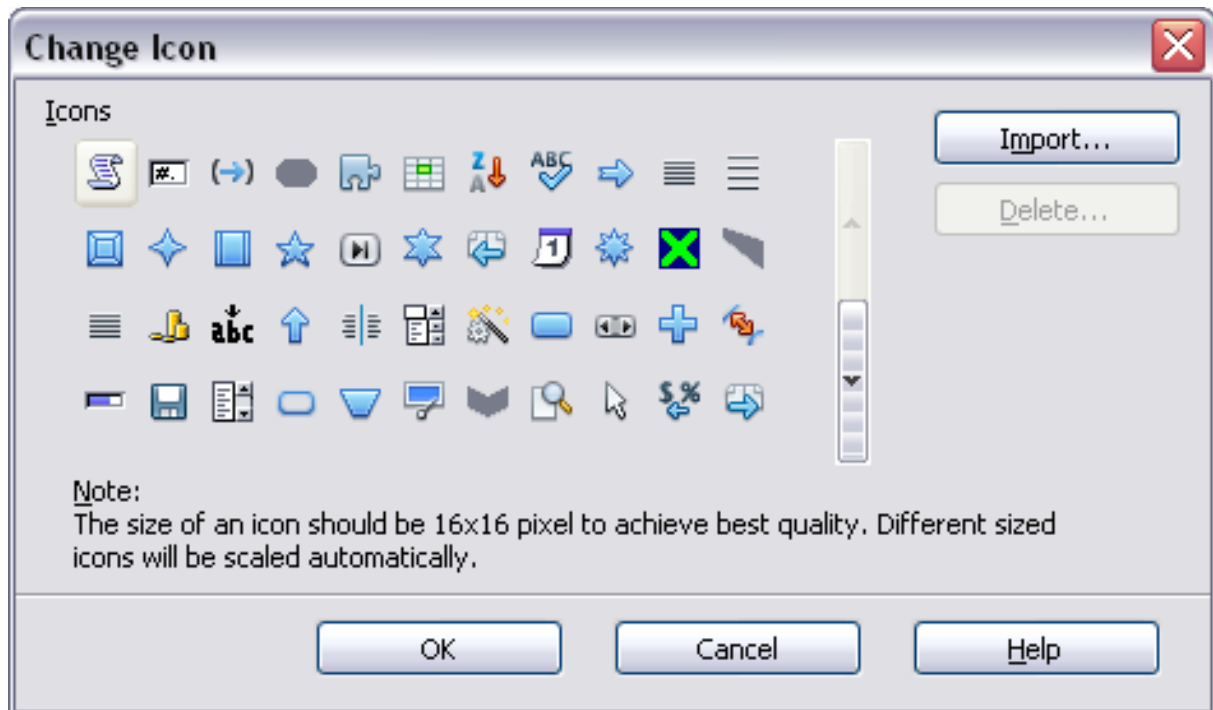


Figure 22: Change Icon dialog

Customizing Keyboard Shortcuts

In addition to using the built-in keyboard shortcuts (listed in Appendix A), you can define your own. You can assign shortcuts to standard OpenOffice functions or your macros and save them for use with the entire OpenOffice suite or only for Calc.

Caution



Be careful when reassigning your operating system's or OpenOffice's predefined shortcut keys. Many key assignments are universally understood shortcuts, such as *F1* for Help, and are always expected to provide certain results. Although you can easily reset the shortcut key assignments to the defaults, changing some common shortcut keys can cause confusion, frustration and possible data loss or corruption, especially if other users share your computer.

To adapt shortcut keys to your needs, use the Customize dialog, as described below.

- 1) Select **Tools > Customize > Keyboard**. The *Keyboard* tab of the Customize dialog opens.
- 2) To have the shortcut key assignment available only with Calc, select **Calc** in the upper-right corner of the tab; otherwise, select **OpenOffice** to make it available to every component.

- 3) Next, select the required function from the *Category* and *Function* lists.
- 4) Now select the desired shortcut keys in the *Shortcut keys* list and click the **Modify** button at the upper right.
- 5) Click **OK** to accept the change. Now the chosen shortcut keys will execute the function chosen in step 3 above whenever they are pressed.

Tip

Once you have selected any shortcut in the *Shortcut keys* list, you can jump to a desired shortcut by pressing the associated keys. For example, you can click on *F1*, the first entry in the list, and jump to *Ctrl + Shift + S* by pressing that key combination.

Note

All existing shortcut keys for the currently selected *Function* are listed in the *Keys* selection box. If the *Keys* list is empty, it indicates that the chosen key combination is free for use. If it were not, and you wanted to reassign a shortcut key combination that is already in use, you must first delete the existing key.

Shortcut keys that are grayed out in the listing on the Customize dialog, such as *F1* and *F10*, are not available for reassignment.

Example: Assigning Styles to Shortcut Keys

You can configure shortcut keys to quickly assign styles in your document.

- 1) On the *Keyboard* tab of the Customize dialog (Figure 23), choose the shortcut keys you want to assign a style to. In this example, we have chosen *Ctrl+3*.

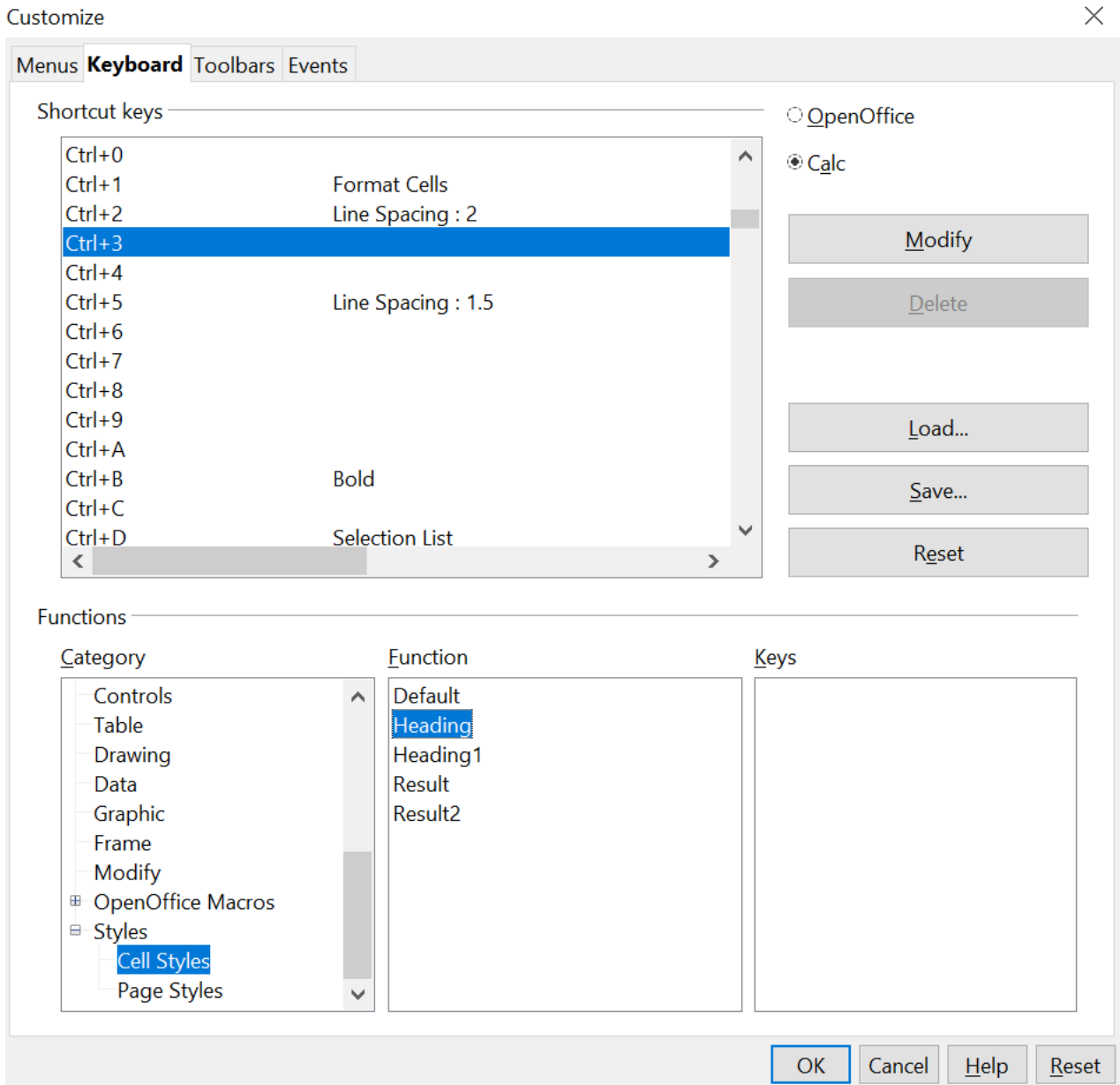


Figure 23: Assigning a cell style to a key combination

- 2) In the *Functions* section at the bottom of the dialog, scroll down in the Category list to *Styles*. Click the + sign to expand the list of styles.
- 3) Choose the category of style. (This example uses a cell style, but you can also choose page styles.) The *Function* list now displays the names of the available styles for the selected category. The example shows the predefined cell styles.
- 4) To assign *Ctrl+3* to be the shortcut key combination for the *Heading* style, select *Heading* in the *Function* list. Then click **Modify**. *Ctrl+3* now appears in the *Keys* list on the right, and *Heading* appears next to *Ctrl+3* in the Shortcut keys box at the top.
- 5) Make any other required changes, and then click **OK** to save these settings and close the dialog.

Saving Changes to a File

Changes to the shortcut key assignments can be saved in a keyboard configuration file for use at a later time, permitting you to create and apply different configurations as the need arises. To save keyboard shortcuts to a file:

- 1) After making your keyboard shortcut assignments, click the **Save** button on the Customize dialog.
- 2) In the Save Keyboard Configuration dialog, select *All files* from the **Save as Type** list.
- 3) Next, enter a name for the keyboard configuration file in the **File name** box, or select an existing file from the list. If you need to, browse to find a file from another location.
- 4) Click **Save**. A confirmation dialog appears if you are about to overwrite an existing file. Otherwise, there will be no feedback, and the file will be saved.

Loading a Saved Keyboard Configuration

To load a saved keyboard configuration file and replace your existing configuration, click the **Load** button of the Customize dialog, then select the configuration file from the Load Keyboard Configuration dialog.

Resetting the Shortcut Keys

To reset all of the keyboard shortcuts to their default values, click the **Reset** button near the bottom right of the Customize dialog. Use this feature with care as no confirmation dialog will be displayed; the defaults will be set without any further notice or user input.

Running Macros from Key Combinations

You can also define shortcut key combinations that will run macros. These shortcut keys are strictly user-defined; none are built in. For more information on macros, see Chapter 12 (Calc Macros).

Adding Functionality with Extensions

An extension is a package that can be installed into OpenOffice to add new functionality.

Although individual extensions can be found in different places, the official OpenOffice extension repository is located at: <https://extensions.openoffice.org/>. Some extensions are free of charge, while others are available for a fee. Check the descriptions to see what licenses and fees apply to the ones that interest you.

Installing Extensions

To install an extension, take these steps:

- 1) Download an extension and save it anywhere on your computer.
- 2) In OpenOffice, select **Tools > Extension Manager** from the menu bar. In the Extension Manager dialog (Figure 24), click **Add**.
- 3) A file browser window opens. Find and select the extension you want to install and click **Open**. The extension begins installing. You may be asked to accept a license agreement.
- 4) When the installation is complete, the extension is listed in the Extension Manager dialog.

Tip

To get extensions that are listed in the repository, you can open the Extension Manager and click the **Get more extensions online** link. You do not need to download them separately as in step 1 above.

Note

To install a *shared* extension, you need write access to the OpenOffice installation directory.

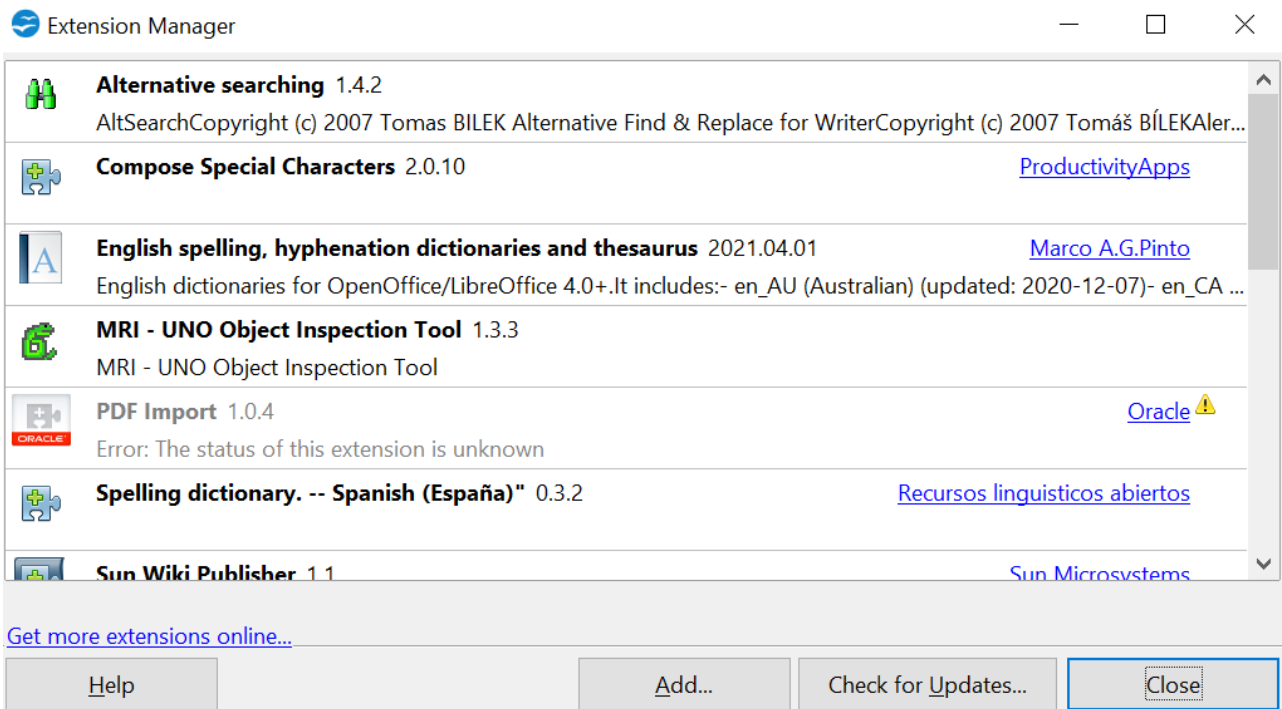


Figure 24: Installing an extension